Streamlining IT Procurement:

Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer Project

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Semester: 5

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Introduction :

In any organization, IT procurement plays a vital role in maintaining employee productivity. At present, the process of ordering standard laptops is handled manually. This manual approach often leads to delays, missed configuration steps, and inefficient use of the hardware team. To overcome these issues, this project titled “Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer” has been developed using ServiceNow. The core concept is to automate the laptop request lifecycle. Once a user requests a Standard Laptop from the Service Catalog and the request is approved, the system automatically creates a Catalog Task with the short description “Laptop need to Configured” and assigns it to the Hardware group. This automation, built using Flow Designer, eliminates manual work, reduces errors, and ensures timely configuration, thereby improving overall efficiency and user satisfaction.

Project Objective:

The main objective of this project is to automate the standard laptop ordering process using ServiceNow Flow Designer.

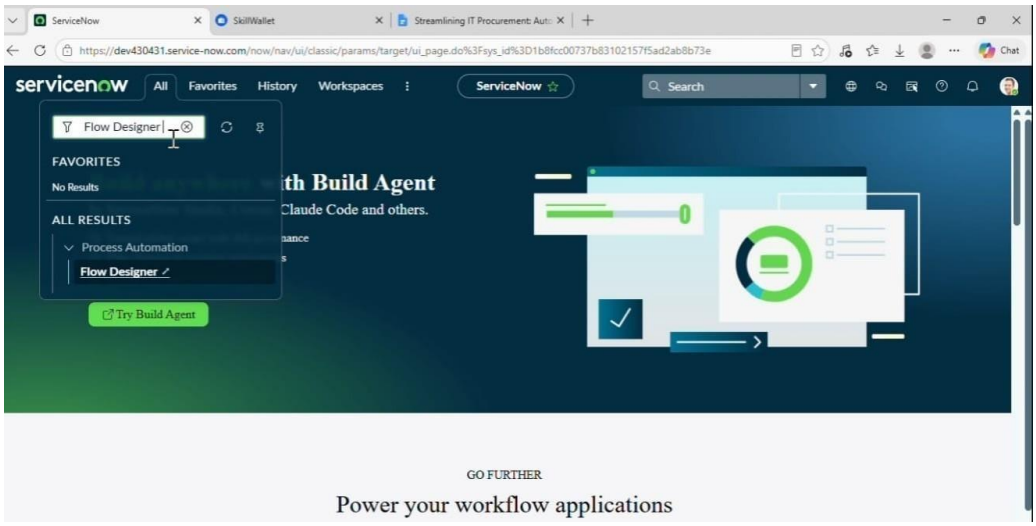
The specific objectives are:

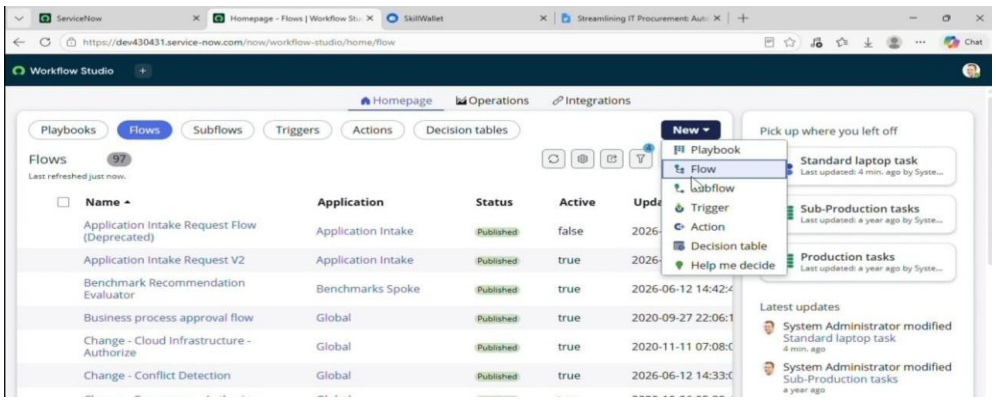
- To create a seamless and automated experience for users requesting standard laptops.
- To automatically generate a configuration task with the short description “Laptop need to Configured” after the approval stage.
- To automatically assign the generated task to the Hardware assignment group to ensure prompt action.
- To eliminate manual intervention and reduce errors in the procurement process.
- To improve the overall efficiency and resource utilization of the IT department.

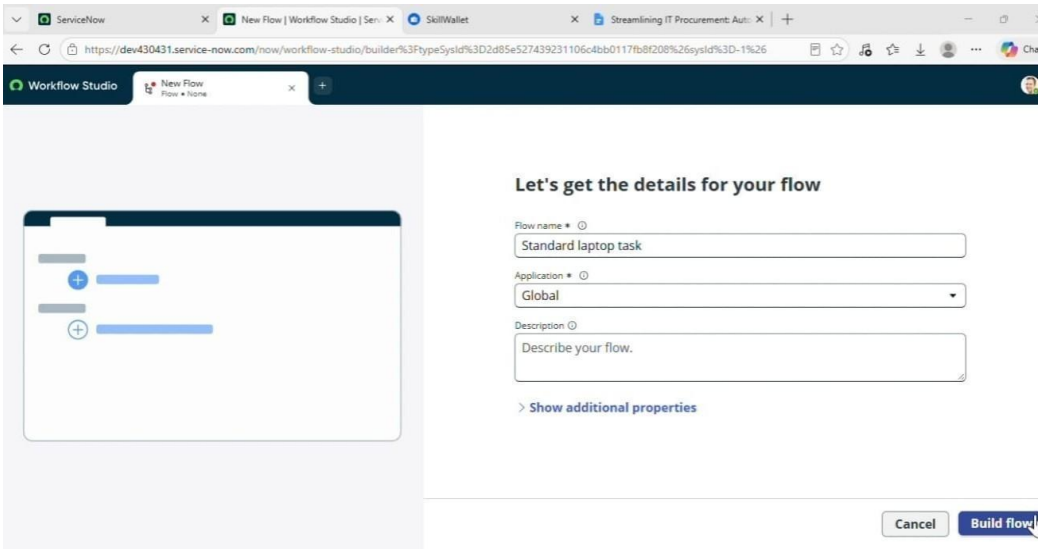
Milestone 1 : Flow Creation

Activity 1: Create a Flow to Create Catalog task to update the short description after Approval the service Request and it will be Assignment group to Hardware.

1. Open service now.
2. Click on All >> search for Flow Designer
3. Click on Flow Designer under Process Automation.
4. After opening Flow Designer Click on new and select Flow.
5. Under Flow properties Give Flow Name as “ Standard laptop task”.
6. Application should be Global.
7. Select Run user as “ System user ” from that choice.
8. Click on Submit.



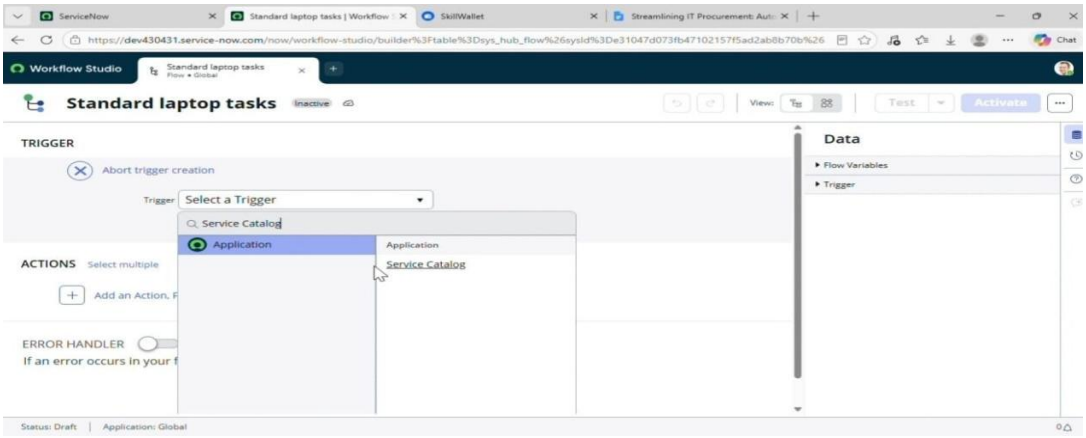


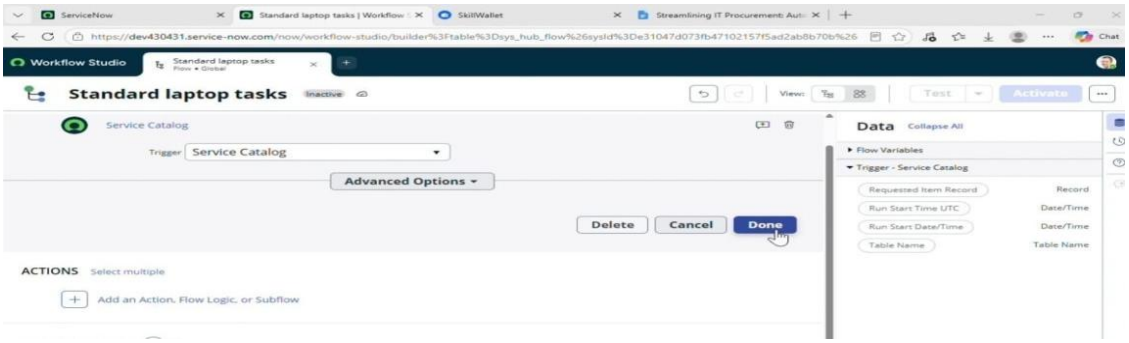


9. Click on Add a trigger.

10. Select the trigger in that Search for " Service Catalog " and select that.

11. After that click on Done.





12. Now under Actions.

13. Click on Add an action.

14. Select action in that search for " Create Catalog Task " and select that.

15.Mention these in that action

16.Action as Create Catalog Task

17.Drag and drop the Requested Item Record in the Request item.

18.Table will be auto populated as a Catalog Task.

19.Mention the short description as “ Laptop need to Configured ”.

20.Click on add field value

21.Select description field and value as “ Laptop need to Configured ”.

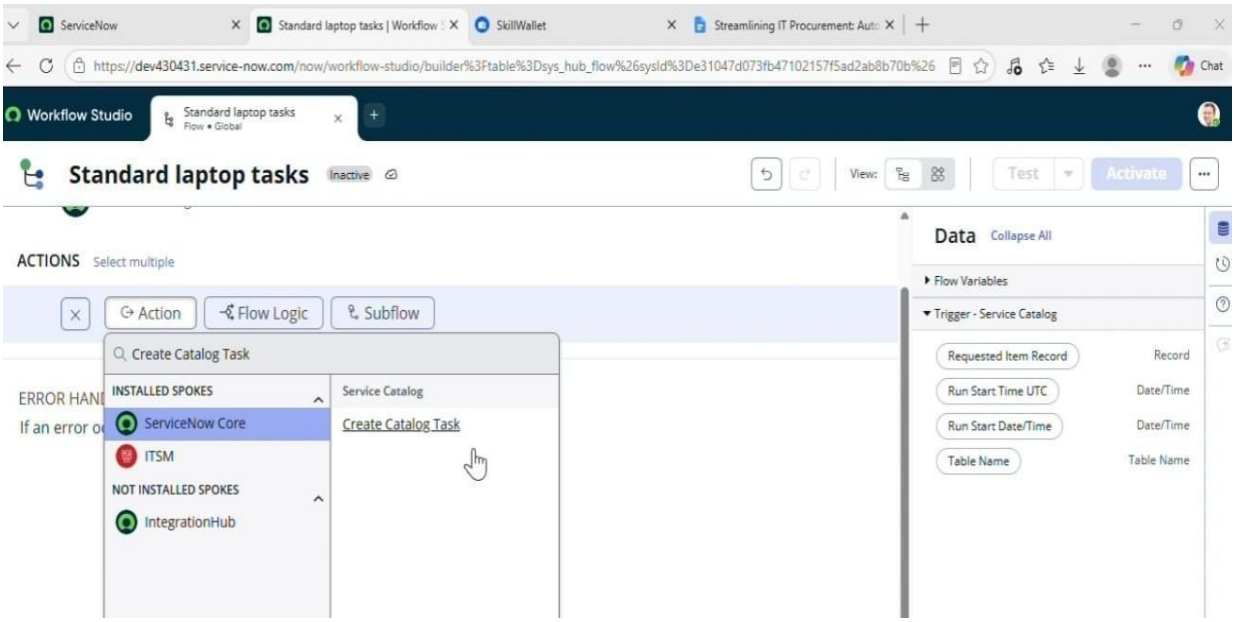
22.Select Assignment group field and value as “ Hardware ”.

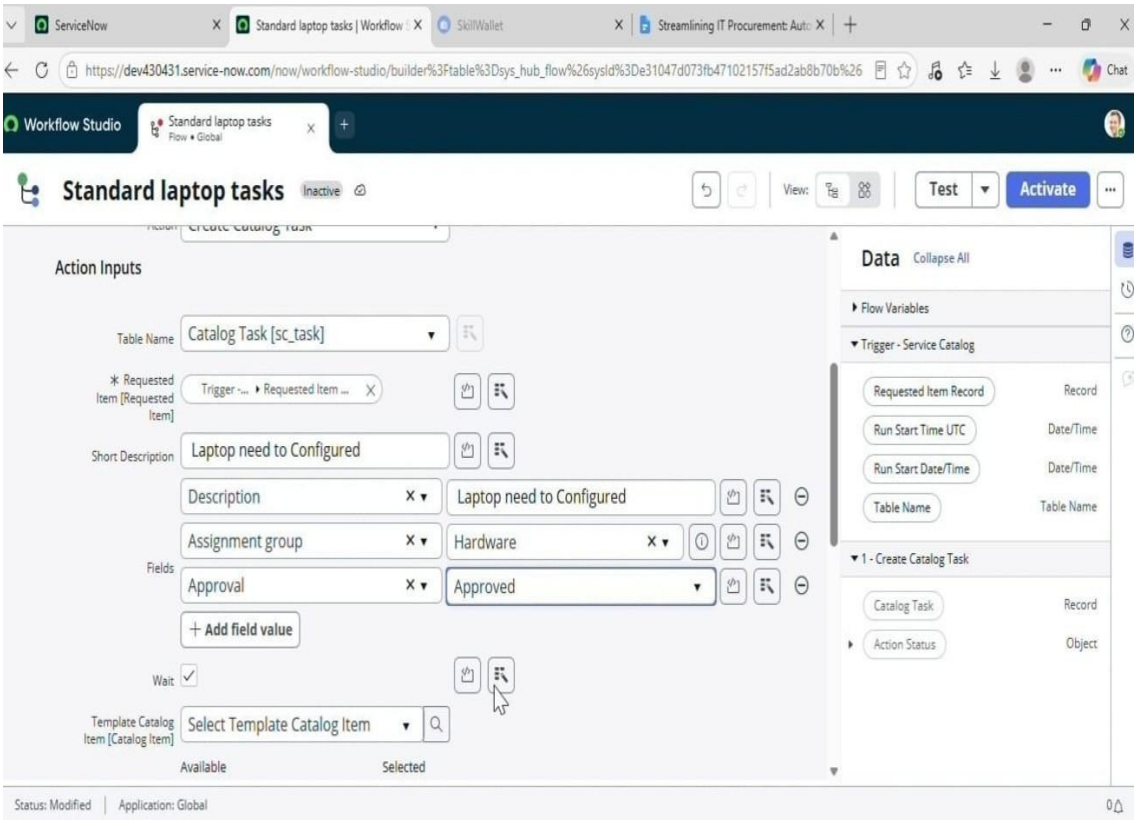
23.Select Approval field and value as “ Approved ”.

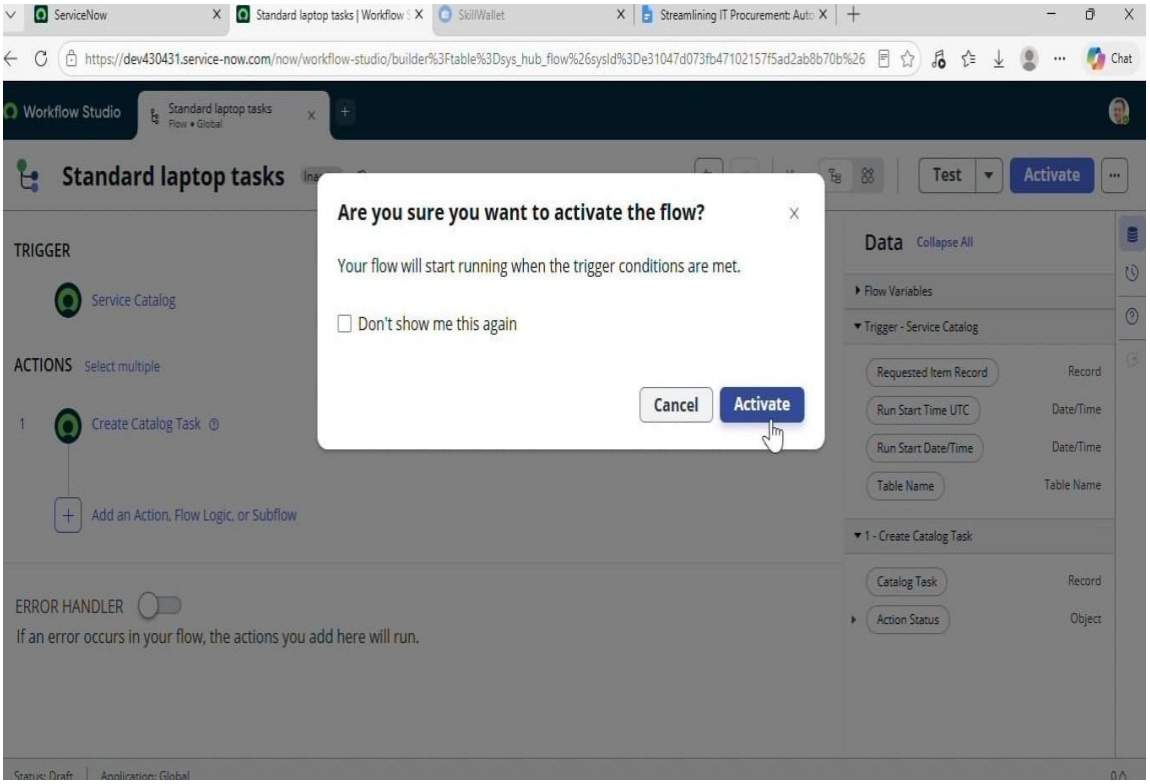
24.Leave the remaining as default and click on Done.

25.Click on save the Flow.

26.And Click on Activate again click on Activate.



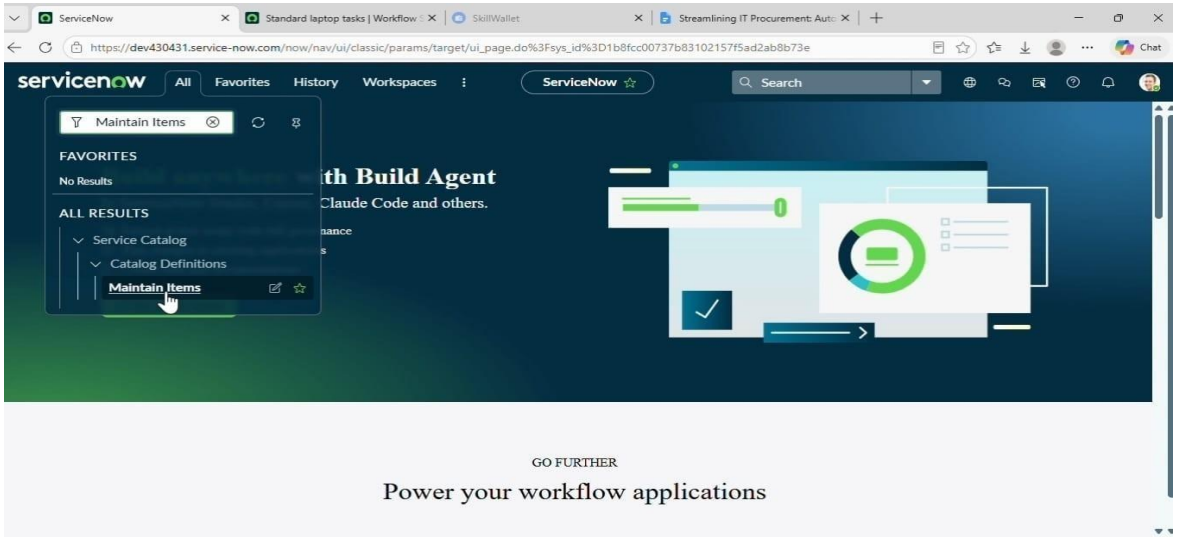

ServiceNow
Standard laptop tasks | Workflow
SkillWallet
Streamlining IT Procurement: Auto
https://dev430431.service-now.com/now/workflow-studio/builder%3Ftable%3Dsys_hub_flow%26sysId%3De31047d073fb47102157f5ad2ab8b70b%26
Chat
Workflow Studio
Standard laptop tasks
Flow • Global
Standard laptop tasks
Inactive
View:
Test
Activate
Action Inputs
Table Name
Catalog Task [sc_task]
* Requested Item [Requested Item]
Trigger -... ▸ Requested Item ...
Short Description
Laptop need to Configured
Fields
Description
Laptop need to Configured
Assignment group
Hardware
Approval
Approved
+ Add field value
Wait
Template Catalog Item [Catalog Item]
Select Template Catalog Item
Available
Selected
Data
Collapse All
Flow Variables
Trigger - Service Catalog
Requested Item Record
Record
Run Start Time UTC
Date/Time
Run Start Date/Time
Date/Time
Table Name
Table Name
1 - Create Catalog Task
Catalog Task
Record
Action Status
Object
Status: Modified
Application: Global


ServiceNow
Standard laptop tasks | Workflow
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Streamlining IT Procurement: Auto
https://dev430431.service-now.com/now/workflow-studio/builder%3Ftable%3Dsys_hub_flow%26sysId%3De31047d073fb47102157f5ad2ab8b70b%26
Chat
Workflow Studio
Standard laptop tasks
Flow • Global
Standard laptop tasks
Test
Activate
Are you sure you want to activate the flow?
Your flow will start running when the trigger conditions are met.
Don't show me this again
Cancel
Activate
TRIGGER
Service Catalog
ACTIONS
Select multiple
1
Create Catalog Task
Add an Action, Flow Logic, or Subflow
ERROR HANDLER
If an error occurs in your flow, the actions you add here will run.
Data
Collapse All
Flow Variables
Trigger - Service Catalog
Requested Item Record
Record
Run Start Time UTC
Date/Time
Run Start Date/Time
Date/Time
Table Name
Table Name
1 - Create Catalog Task
Catalog Task
Record
Action Status
Object

Milestone 2 : Flow assignment

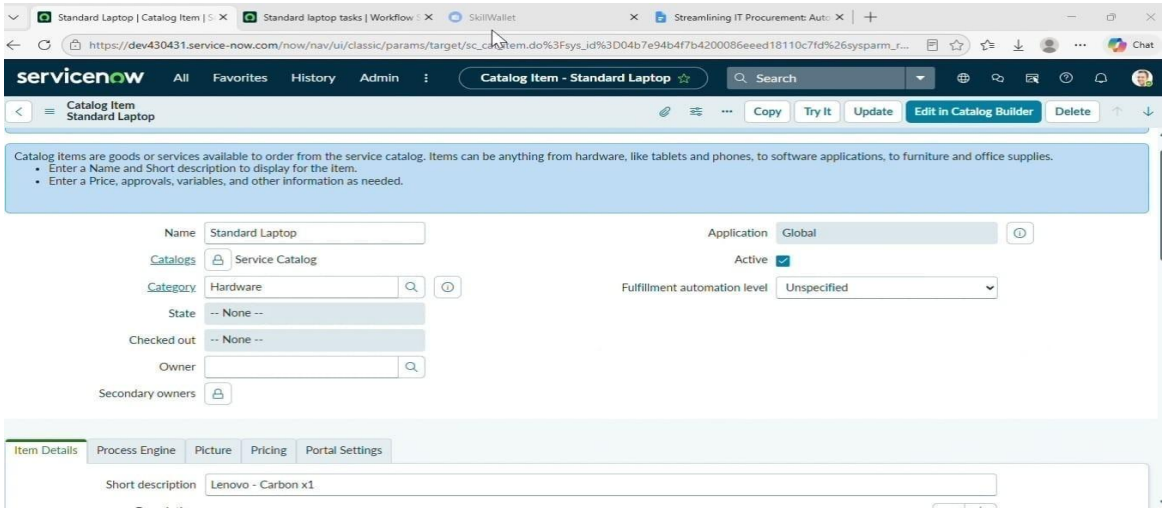
Activity 1 : Flow Assignment to Standard laptop service Catalog.

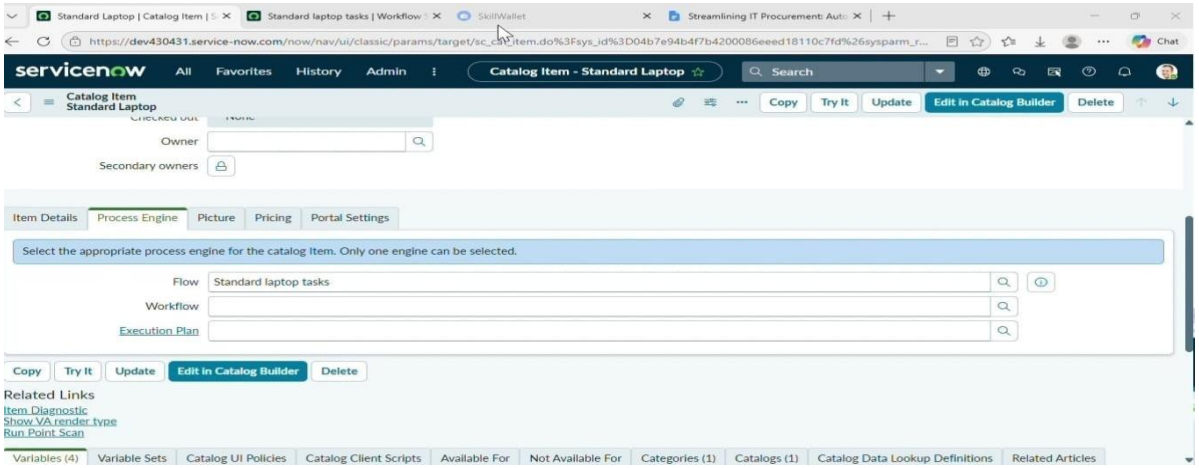
1. Open ServiceNow.
2. Click on all search for Maintain Items.
3. Select Maintain Items.



4. Under the name field search for Standard Laptop Select that record.
5. Under that record select Process engine
6. Remove the remaining automations and add Flow.
7. Add the flow that was created with the name “ Standard Laptop Task”.

Click on the menu to save the

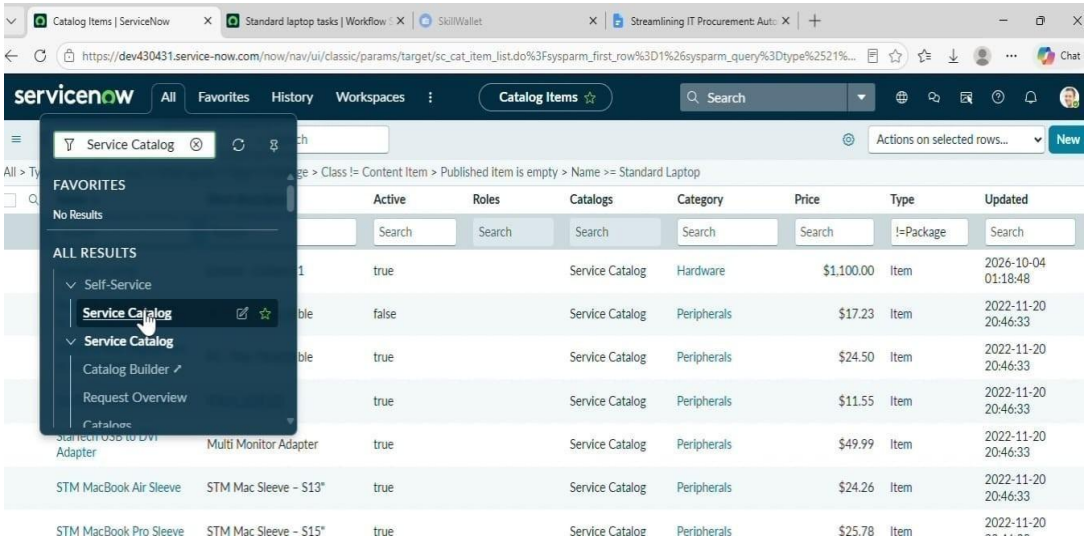




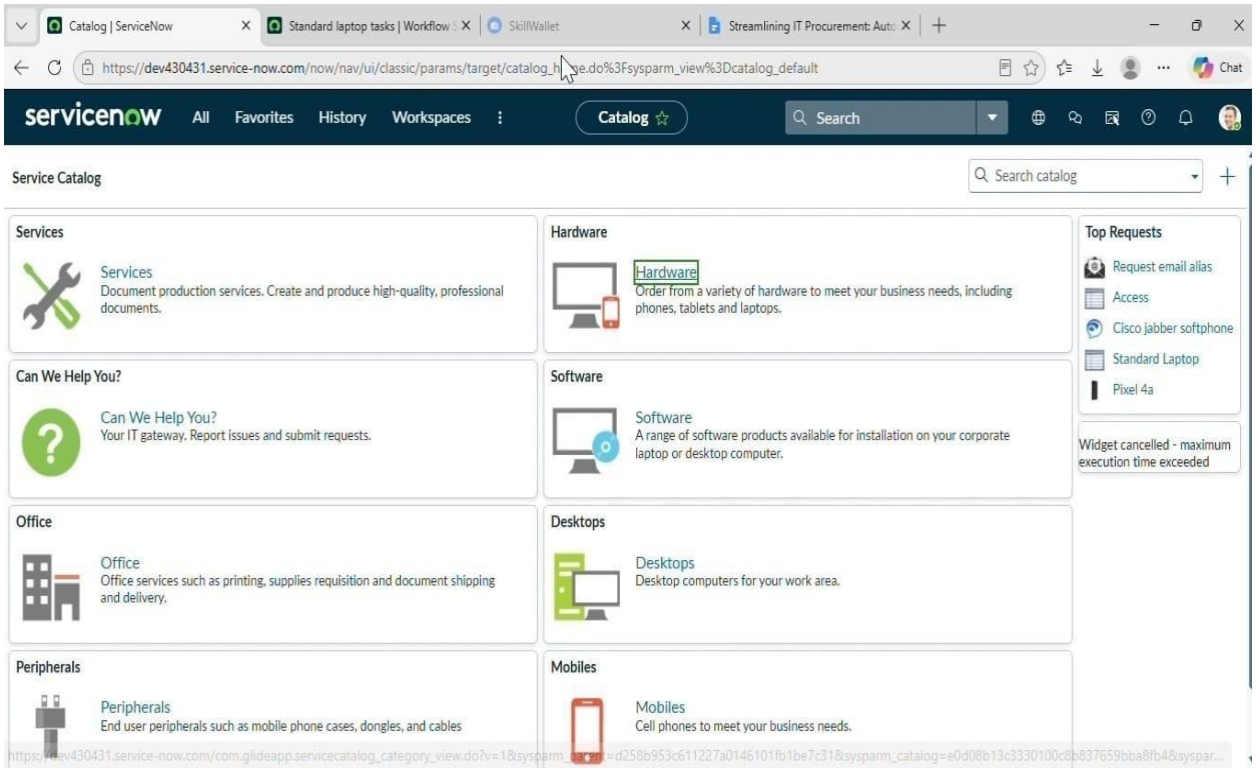
Milestone 3 : Service Catalog

Activity 1: Service Catalog for placing order and get Approval

1. Click on All >> Search for “ Service Catalog ”.

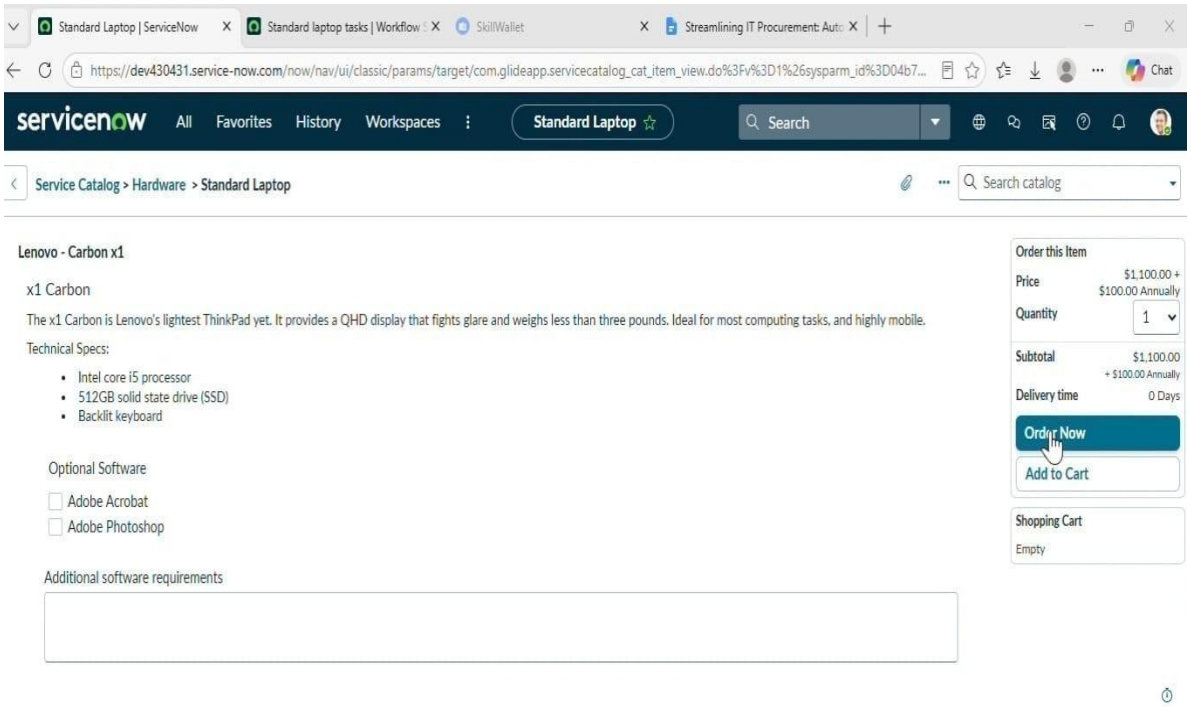


2.Click on Service Catalog >> click on Hardware.



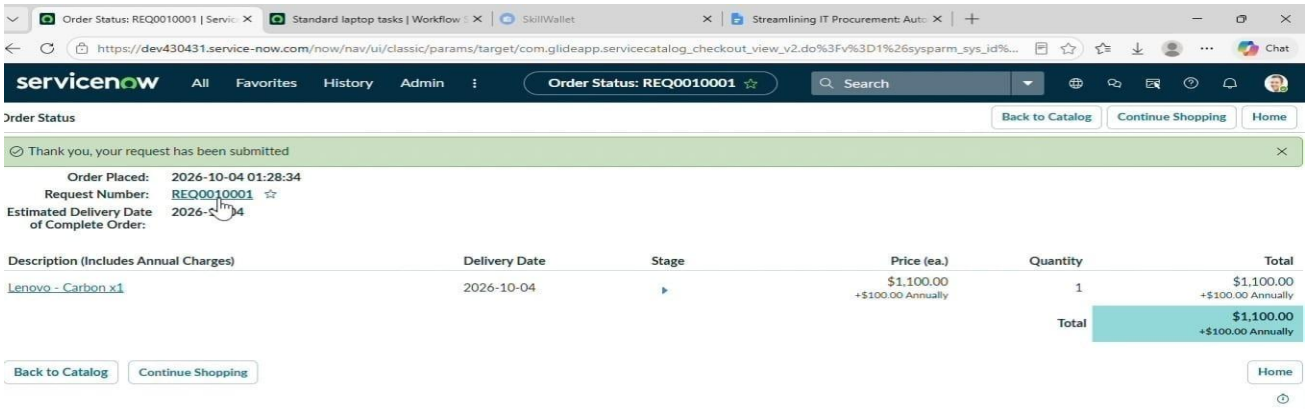
3.Scroll a bit to find the “ Standard Laptop ” click on that.

4.After that click on “ Order Now ” to place the request.



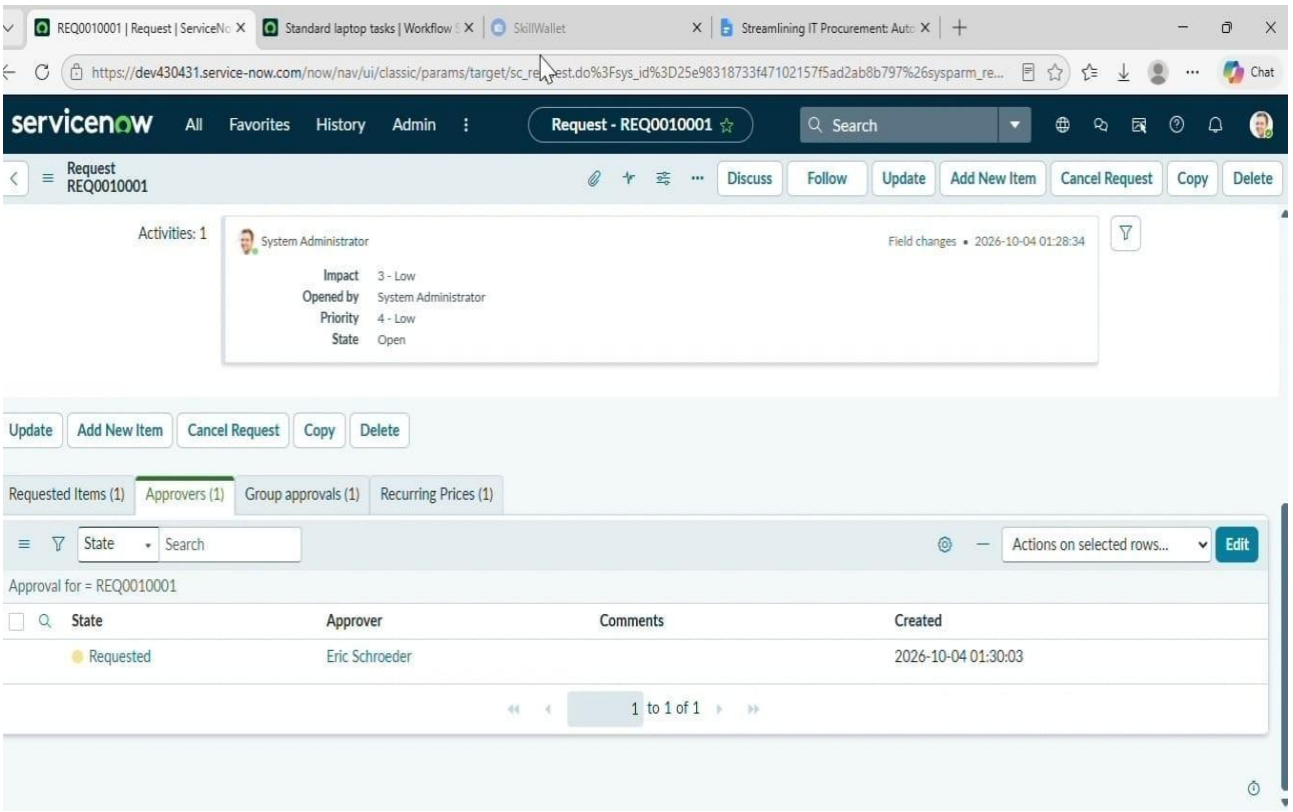
5.Now we will see the Order status

6.In that click on the Request Number

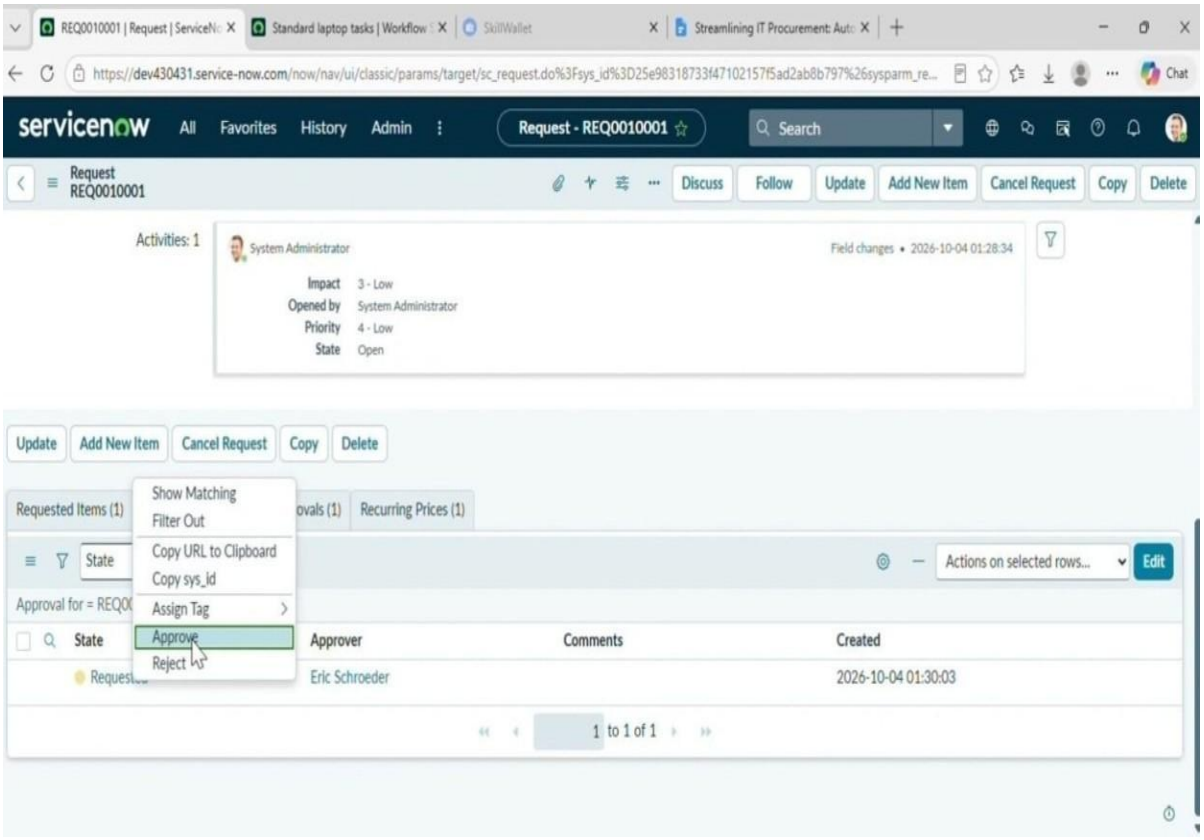


7.It will open the Requested number record.

8.Scroll down Click on the Approvers Section.



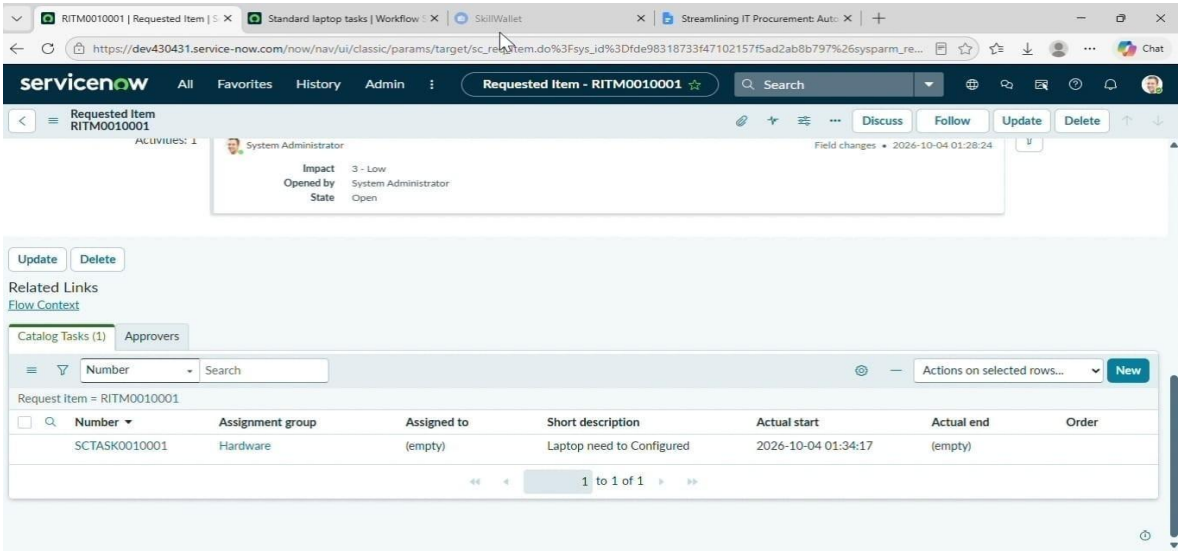
9.Right Click on the Record to see config in that Click on the Approve.



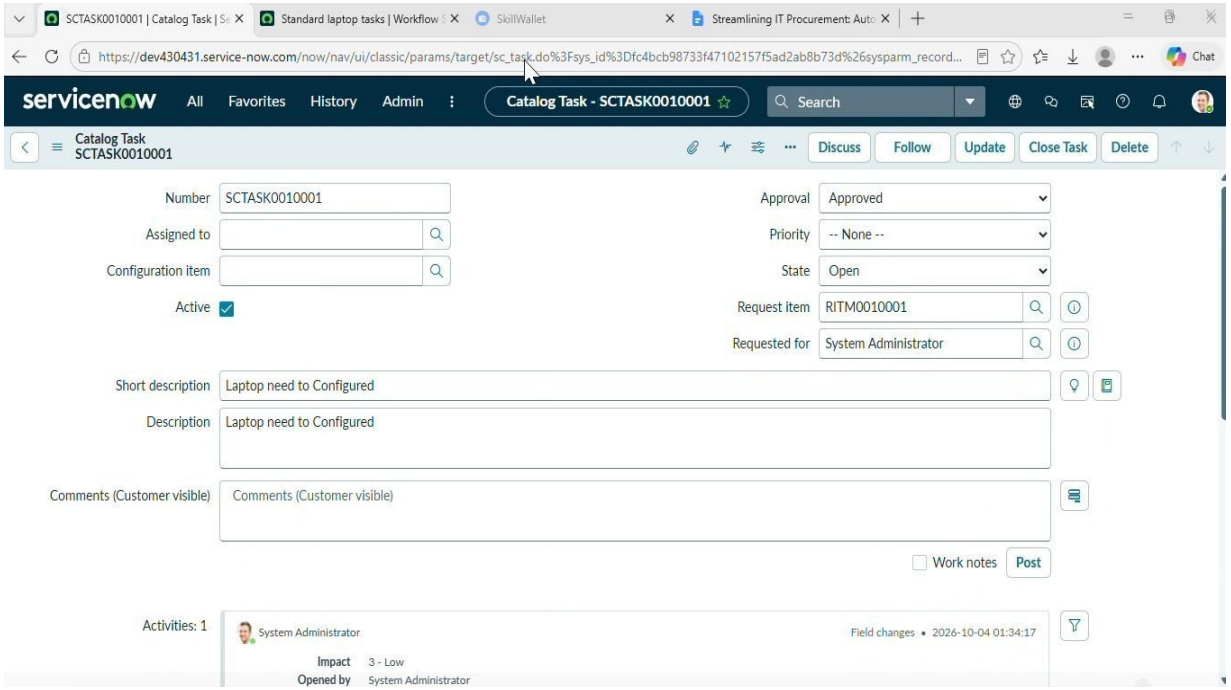
10.Then click on the Requested item Section

11.Open that Requested Item record

12.Scroll down to the “ Catalog tasks ” Section



13.Open the record to see the updated status of the record with Short description and Assigned group.



Conclusion :

By automating the standard laptop procurement process with ServiceNow's Flow Designer, the project effectively addresses inefficiencies and reduces manual overhead. This streamlined workflow ensures timely configuration of laptops, minimizes user wait times, and enhances overall productivity within the IT department. The implementation of this automated solution not only optimizes resource allocation but also significantly improves the user experience by providing a seamless and efficient procurement process.